Stay Safe Online - Prevention Checklist for College Students

Essential Cybersecurity Tips

Financial & UPI Safety (Critical for Indian Students)

☐ **Never share UPI PIN or OTP with anyone** - Banks and UPI apps will NEVER ask for your PIN or OTP via call, SMS, or email. No legitimate transaction requires sharing these codes.
☐ **Verify payment requests before approving** - Always double-check the recipient's name, UPI ID, and amount before confirming any payment. Scammers often send fake payment requests disguised as refunds or prizes.
☐ **Enable two-factor authentication on banking apps** - Use biometric authentication (fingerprint/face recognition) along with your PIN for added security on all financial apps.
☐ **Set transaction limits** - Configure daily transaction limits on your UPI apps (PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm) to minimize potential losses if your account is compromised.

General Online Safety

☐ **Use strong, unique passwords for each account** - Create passwords with at least 12 characters including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters. Never reuse passwords across different platforms.
☐ **Think before you click** - Hover over links to see the actual URL before clicking. Be suspicious of shortened URLs (bit.ly, tinyurl) in unsolicited messages. Verify sender identity before clicking attachments.
☐ **Keep your software updated** - Regularly update your phone's operating system, apps, and antivirus software. Enable automatic updates whenever possible to patch security vulnerabilities.
☐ **Review app permissions regularly** - Check which apps have access to your contacts, location, camera, and microphone. Revoke unnecessary permissions that pose privacy risks.
☐ **Use secure networks** - Avoid conducting financial transactions or accessing sensitive information on public Wi-Fi networks. Use a VPN when connecting to unsecured networks.
☐ **Be cautious with social media sharing** - Don't post real-time location updates, travel plans, or personal information like phone numbers and addresses publicly. Adjust privacy settings to limit who can see your posts.

🚨 If You're a Victim - Report Immediately

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

Website: cybercrime.gov.in

- File online complaints 24/7
- Track your complaint status

- Anonymous reporting available

National Helpline

Call: 1930

- Toll-free number for immediate assistance
- Available for reporting financial fraud and cybercrimes
- Trained professionals to guide you through the reporting process

Important Notes:

- Report within the first 24 hours for better chances of fund recovery
- Keep all evidence: screenshots, transaction IDs, messages, and call recordings
- Block the fraudulent account/number immediately after reporting

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Remember: Prevention is better than cure. Stay alert, stay safe! 🔒